

In some programs, you'll be asked to specify pathnames for a file. A pathname is just a list of every folder the file you're accessing is in, starting with the name of the disk it's on and ending with the name of the file it's on. For example, the pathname of the Calculator desk accessory, if you've installed it on a Q Drive, is :Q1:System:Desk.Accs:Calculator. This tells the computer that the file is on the disk Q1, and that to get to it you must first open the System folder and then the Desk.Accs folder before finding the Calculator desk accessory (Figure 6J).

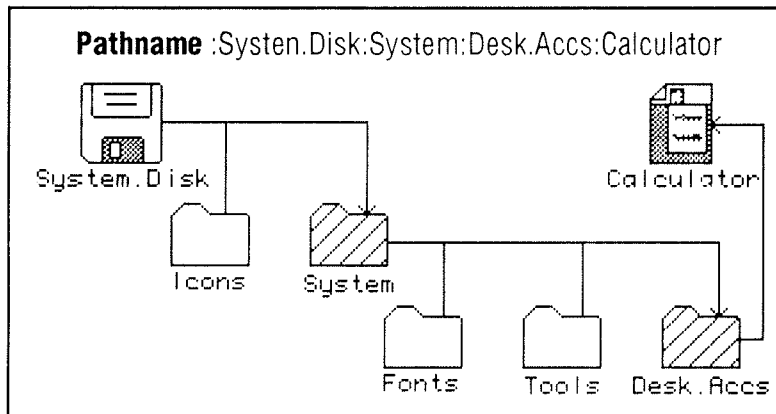


Figure 6J—How System 6 Follows Pathnames

▲ By The Way...

In System 6, you can use colons (:) or slashes (/) to separate the folders in a pathname, but you have to be consistent (you can't use both separators in the same pathname). When you're using a ProDOS 8 program, like AppleWorks, you have to use slashes.

The IIGS Desktop is supposed to protect us from having to concern ourselves about directories by representing them graphically. We mention the concept for two reasons:

First, a lot of older programs still use the subdirectory terminology, so it's important to relate the two ways of talking about your disk contents. Graphic user interfaces are relatively new, and the Apple II's been around for a *long* time.

Second, a lot of old-time Apple users are familiar with the subdirectory concept but have less experience with windows and icons. The two concepts are just different ways of thinking about a hierarchical organization, and that's important to know.